

Human capital: Investment in Education, Skill Development, and Employment:

As we move towards the destination of 'Viksit Bharat', the role of human capital becomes increasingly significant. Human capital is defined as the skills, knowledge, health, and productivity of the workforce, all of which together drives our national development. Shaping India's workforce to become more capable, skilled, and highly ready to meet the demands of a modern economy encompasses many dimensions. However, the primary objective is to develop every individual of the workforce to contribute meaningfully to the nation's progress by focusing on the core pillars of education, skill development, and employment.

India has laid a strong foundation that ensures the 'educational rights' of every individual through the constitution. But prioritizing practical, hands-on skills over rote memorization can be effectively implemented using 'skill development'. Quality education combined with practical skills results in employment opportunities, ensuring financial stability for individuals and economical growth for the nation.

The above pillars will be fully functional only if there exists no discrimination based on sex, religion, caste, or place of birth. Assurance of equality must be ensured through the nation's policies and civic responsibility of every individual. Our India can harness the full potential of its workforce only when these three pillars are established along with equality for everyone.

First pillar:

In India, all children aged 6-14 are entitled to fundamental knowledge under Article 21-A, ensuring a strong foundation for the first pillar. While the curricula devised by each state are commendable, the quality of education delivered through these curricula remains a challenge. Even though 'Unity in diversity', is the strength of India, there should be a unified curricula focusing on conceptual learning rather than rote memorization for the subjects of mathematics and science.

India's AI Impact Summit aims to focus on AI-enabled, personalized, and interactive education. This is also reflected in the Union Budget for the year 2026-27, with an increase in the allocation for the Department of School Education & Literacy [6.35% increase] and the Department of Higher Education [11.28% increase]. Furthermore, the establishment of Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, and Comics content creator labs in 15,000 secondary schools and 500 colleges indicates the shift towards digital education.

Along with this, the infrastructure of our education system should change to shift from conventional examinations to project-based examinations. This can only be done with well-talented teachers who can guide students efficiently.

Outcome in human capital:

- The above-mentioned facilities must not be limited with top-tier institutions. These facilities must reach to every individual. If this happens, then the first pillar serves as a platform for future-ready workforce.
- Fundamental knowledge along with civic responsibility, discipline and creativity is gained.

Second pillar:

The second pillar, 'Skill Development', acts as a bridge between theoretical and practical knowledge. In addition to theoretical knowledge, students must be introduced to the real-world problems faced by industries through the establishment of 'Skill Development Centres' in schools and colleges. This will make every individual market-ready and financially sound. This pillar does not restrict itself to technical or engineering skills alone, but also includes other 'extra-curricular' skills such as music, dance, writing, sewing, pottery, etc.

Ancient Indian skills such as Kalaripayattu, Chess, and Meditation can also be introduced, helping the nation hold on to its rich heritage while imparting useful skills to the students. Schools and colleges can work together through Memorandums of Exchange, including technical talks, demonstrations, and workshops. Proper maintenance of the labs and equipment is a must so that all the students can make use of the facilities provided.

Outcome in human capital:

- Financial stability along with self-confidence in themselves is assured.
- Ancient Indian skills can be preserved in the form of extra-curricular activities – cultural literacy is maintained – health [through not being depressed and having self-confidence] and wealth [the arts of India] is preserved

Third pillar:

The third and final pillar is 'Employment.' When individuals benefit from the first two pillars, employment opportunities naturally follow. Indians seek employment opportunities abroad because they are concerned about low levels of income, lack of support, and burnout. Thus, the recently enacted New Labour Law reforms[2025] ensure a work-life balance, appropriate compensation for employees, and skill-based employment. This includes a mandatory 50% basic wage component, universal minimum wages, social security for gig workers, a 4-day workweek option, one-year gratuity eligibility, and digital compliance. This leads to a sense of equality and job security.

Furthermore, government should encourage the policies which aims to fund startups and support entrepreneurs who is interested in investing within India. These initiatives result in

more job opportunities. Also, startup initiatives with a focus on Swadeshi must be promoted and must also ensure that the quality of domestically produced goods meets or exceeds existing market standards.

Outcome in human capital:

- It strengthens India's economy by creating jobs and promotes entrepreneurship.
- Results in a skilled, motivated workforce while encouraging Swadeshi and domestic innovation.

Conclusion:

If the outcomes of all three pillars are effectively ensured, India's workforce becomes unstoppable. Such a strong, skilled, and self-confident workforce, will lead to an increase in human capital. The increase in human capital leads to the increase of nation's income, its wealth, and the financial security of the people.

To achieve such a workforce with equality ensured, India must focus on:

- Investment in modern infrastructure and digital learning tools
- Industry-aligned practical training programs
- Encouraging entrepreneurship and supporting startups

Thus, if equality is ensured and the three pillars: Education, Skill Development, and Employment are effectively implemented along with the steps discussed above, then nothing can stop India from its goal of achieving 'Viksit Bharat.' A united, powerful and happy workforce will help India in becoming a global leader in the areas of Productivity, Sustainability, and Technology.

Jai Hind